

The True Cost of Bananas

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The Case Profile & Conflict

Bananas are grown mainly in countries like Ecuador, Guatemala, and Costa Rica before being sold in countries such as Canada and the United States. Historically, powerful Transnational Corporations (TNCs) controlled large amounts of land and influenced governments, creating what became known as “Banana Republics.”

Today, conflict still exists in the banana industry. Plantation workers are often exposed to toxic chemicals from aerial pesticide spraying, and monoculture farming damages soil and ecosystems. Fair Trade bananas cost slightly more, but the extra money helps provide fair wages, safer working conditions, and more sustainable farming practices.

Influencing Buying Decisions

Stores can encourage people to buy Fair Trade bananas in different ways. Fair Trade bananas can be placed at eye level so shoppers notice them first. Stores can also compare them to more expensive snacks so the extra cost seems small. Signs saying “Most shoppers choose Fair Trade bananas” can influence people because they like to follow what others are doing. Pictures and stories of workers and families can also help shoppers understand the human side of the product instead of only thinking about price.

The “Is It Worth It?” Slide

- Fair Trade bananas have many benefits. Workers have safer conditions and less contact with harmful chemicals. Farmers are paid more fairly so they can support their families.
- Fair Trade farming also helps protect the soil and environment. Spending one extra dollar can help communities get clean water, schools, healthcare, and safer farms. The extra money is not just for bananas it helps improve people's lives.

The Conceptual Shift Narrative & Pitch (SCO 4.1.9)

Many people see bananas as just a cheap everyday food. After learning about worker treatment and environmental damage, consumers may start thinking differently. They begin to understand that low prices can come from unfair treatment and unsafe farming. The presentation could start with pictures of old banana plantations and large companies controlling farms. It could then show pesticide spraying and damage to the land before showing Fair Trade farms with safer working conditions and healthier communities. The presentation could end, “A banana should not cost someone their health or future.”

Sources -

- https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/pesticides?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- https://www.fairtrade.net/en/products/Fairtrade_products/Bananas.html
- https://www.britannica.com/topic/banana-republic?utm_source=chatgpt.com